“I’m a woman—he doesn’t see me as a threat or suspect me at all.”

“He’s a Gestapo officer.” André frowned. “Everyone is a suspect.”

“He’s human. He needs someone to listen. That’s all.”

“Does he know about me?”

“Yes. He approved my travel request to come here. He also reads your letters. He sees all our correspondence before we do and sometimes crosses things out.”

“So he knows about *us*?”

She shook her head. “I told him you were my cousin.”

“Your cousin, eh?”

“I could ask him to have you transferred to Glashütte.”

“You’d do that for me?” His eyes brightened.

“Didn’t you save me from that angry German soldier who wanted to arrest me for spying? Now, it’s my chance to return the favor.”

“This is different. You’re dealing with a Gestapo officer.”

“What can I tell him? To see if there’s a match in one of the factories in Glashütte?”

“At Tempelhof, I work on the timing mechanisms for fuses so that when they release the bombs from the Junkers, they explode at the correct altitude. I hate thinking that I’m hurting innocent people. Sometimes . . .”

Rose leaned forward. “What?”

“I alternate the switches, so they won’t work the way they should.”

“Sabotage?”

“If I can. There are a lot of eyes on the assembly line. If I do it too much, they’ll trace it back to me.”

Suddenly, she was seized with the uneasy feeling that even if she could arrange for André to be transferred, what would happen if he sabotaged production in Glashütte, and would she be implicated? Asking him to promise not to do it felt selfish. She didn’t want to be like everyone in Orléans—desperate for safety and comfort and unwilling to take risks.

A light rain began to fall. “Are you ever worried you might be caught?” she asked.

“I used to, but after what they did to Papa . . .” he began, but she brought her finger to his lips.

“I understand,” she said. “Be careful. I don’t want anything to happen to you.”